

Roadside Assistance and Towing Coverage Guide

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Audience: Claims adjusters

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This guide expands on the Roadside Assistance endorsement referenced in the Policy Form Version Comparison with claims-handling detail for towing and disablement events.

1. What Roadside Assistance Covers

Roadside assistance, where purchased and shown on the Declarations page, pays for towing to the nearest qualified repair facility and limited on-site services (jump-start, flat-tire change, lockout assistance, fuel delivery) following a mechanical breakdown or disablement of the covered auto. It is a service benefit distinct from Part D or Part C physical damage coverage and is payable regardless of whether the disablement resulted from a covered accident.

2. Distinguishing Breakdown Towing from Accident Towing

Towing following a mechanical breakdown is adjudicated under the Roadside Assistance endorsement described here. Towing following a covered accident (a collision or comprehensive loss) is instead a component of the Part D or Part C claim itself, since it is an expense directly caused by the covered loss rather than an independent breakdown — these two towing scenarios use different coverage citations and should not be conflated in the claim file even though the service performed (towing a vehicle) looks identical from the policyholder's perspective.

3. Per-Occurrence Limit

Roadside assistance is subject to a per-occurrence dollar limit shown on the Declarations page; a tow exceeding that limit (for example, a long-distance tow from a remote location) is paid up to the limit, with the excess the policyholder's own responsibility, unless the tow qualifies instead as an accident-related tow

under Section 2, which is evaluated against the Part D or Part C limit rather than the roadside-assistance limit.

4. Frequency Limits

Some Roadside Assistance selections carry an annual frequency limit (a maximum number of service calls per policy period) in addition to the per-occurrence dollar limit; both limits are checked independently, since a policyholder could be within the dollar limit on an individual call but have already exhausted the annual frequency limit.

5. Vehicles Not Covered

Roadside assistance applies only to a covered auto listed on the Declarations page — a non-owned or borrowed vehicle the policyholder is driving is not covered under the policyholder's own Roadside Assistance selection, consistent with the general non-owned-vehicle limitation described elsewhere in this corpus for other coverage parts.

6. Repeated Breakdowns and Mechanical Condition

A pattern of repeated roadside-assistance calls for the same vehicle within a short period may indicate an underlying mechanical condition rather than isolated incidents; this is a maintenance issue for the policyholder to address and is not itself a basis for coverage denial of any individual call, but is documented and monitored consistent with the pattern-tracking approach used elsewhere in this corpus (Vendor and Repair Network Management Guide, Section 7).

7. Reimbursement Where No Network Provider Is Available

Where no network towing provider is available (a remote location, after-hours breakdown), the policyholder may arrange towing independently and submit for reimbursement up to the applicable limit; the reimbursement is calculated by the deterministic calculation service against the documented invoice and the Declarations-page limit, following the same computation discipline used throughout this corpus.

8. Documentation Standard

A roadside assistance claim file documents: the disablement cause (to distinguish Section 1 breakdown towing from Section 2 accident towing), the service performed, the invoice or network provider confirmation, and the applicable per-occurrence and frequency limits from the Declarations page.